



The Grand Tour

Visually, *Civ 4* is quite impressive. While due attention has been paid to details such as waves, flowing water and swaying trees, these aren't as performance-hungry as one would fear. The interface is well laid out, and didn't pose too much of a task to understand.

The sound is an impressive part of the game. The background score is full of African and Gregorian chants, and fall gently upon one's ears. The music changes according to what level you are zoomed into in your map—at full zoom, you hear civilisation-specific music for your cities (yes, sitars for India), and as you zoom out, the music changes to

the Gregorian chants again.

What didn't go down too well with this reviewer was the fact that while inconsequential alerts keep popping up right in front of you, the ones that really matter—like when your opponent kills your favourite archers—are put in the top-left corner of the screen, where you aren't really likely to be paying much attention.

Submission

All right, so I started this game with pessimism, and I've been proven wrong. The gameplay is extremely addictive. The battles of wits with opponents are engaging, the humour is cheeky, it looks good, it sounds good, and it makes

you wonder why you missed out on the previous games. A cry of joy and a nine on ten for this game!

For newcomers to the world of turn-based strategy, it's a tad annoying at first, but everything else compensates for that. It's also a game that takes a *really* long time—getting through 6,000 years of the world's civilisations does take a while—so please make sure you pause to have your meals. We don't want you starving to death at your desktops.

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Publisher: 2K Games
Minimum System Configuration: 1 GHz CPU,
256 MB RAM, 32 MB video card with
hardware transform and lighting capabilities

